

ORDER, THE

California's Fifty State Initiative Team

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FACTFILE

NOTABLE MEMBERS

ANTHEM (Henry Hellrung) Actor and team leader, fires electric blasts, flight.

ARALUNE (Rebecca "Becky" Ryan) Pop star, shapeshifter, flight.

CALAMITY (James Wa) Ex-athlete, engineer, superhuman speed, flight.

VIRGINIA "PEPPER" POTTS Executive, uses telepresence equipment to tap Stark satellites and coordinate team strategy.

SUPernaut (Milo Fields) Pilots massive armor suit.

VEDA (Magdalena "Maggie" Neuntauben) Actress, generates and controls golems and can see through their eyes.

BASE Bradbury, California

FIRST APPEARANCE:
Civil War #6 (January 2007)

Two teams have called themselves the Order. The first was the DEFENDERS while the second was created for the Fifty State Initiative (see pp. 118–9).

DEFENDING THE ORDER

One of the first foes the Defenders fought was the alien scientist Yandroth. As he died, he cursed the original Defenders—the HULK, NAMOR, the SILVER SURFER, and DOCTOR STRANGE—to always reunite whenever catastrophe struck the Earth. Worst of all, every time they did, they would become more and more selfish. Unaware of the curse, these Defenders eventually decided to form the Order and take an active interest in shaping the world's future.

The other Defenders figured this out and broke Yandroth's curse, foiling his plan to be reborn with the negative energy the Order was generating around the planet. The Earth goddess Gaea gave NIGHTHAWK the power to call the Defenders together instead, but without any of the side effects. After the end of the Civil War (see pp. 84–5), Tony Stark (IRON MAN) became the director of SHIELD. Already the leader of the AVENGERS, he decided to launch the Fifty

THE ORDER

1 Aralune 2 Supernaut 3 Anthem
4 Calamity 5 Veda 6 Mulholland



In their first solo outing, the Order faced off against the Infernal Man and lost two members, the androids Bannerman Brown and Green.

State Initiative (see pp. 118–9), which planned to put a team of heroes in every state in the nation.

Stark formed the team for California from scratch, using handpicked people without any pre-existing powers. He put his most trusted employee, Pepper POTTS, in charge of the team. For the field leader, he tapped Henry Hellrung, an actor who had played Tony Stark in films—and who also had sponsored Tony in Alcoholics Anonymous. Together, they trained a crew of actors, singers, and other entertainers to become the Initiative's California team. The roster included: Anthem (Henry Hellrung), Aralune, Calamity, Supernaut, and Veda, as well as Aphrodite, Avona, Bannerman Brown and Green, Corona, Heavy, Maul, Mulholland, and Pierce.

The team's structure followed that of the Olympian gods. Stark served as Zeus, Potts as Hera, and Hellrung as Apollo, with the other members of the team in various roles. The roles were more important than the people who filled them. If members misbehaved or disobeyed orders, they could be fired and their powers stripped from them. They were then replaced with eager, new heroes-to-be.

The group first saw action in the final battle against CAPTAIN AMERICA's resistance. They clashed with villains, such as the female gang called the Black Dahlias, controlled by Ezekiel STANE. They also fought against the SKRULLS during the Secret Invasion (see pp. 326–7), being one of the few Initiative teams to have avoided Skrull infiltration. **MF**

ESSENTIAL STORYLINES

• The Order Vol. 1 #1–6

The original Order forms out of Yandroth's curse—and the Defenders stop them.

• The Order Vol. 2 #1–10

The entire run of the second version of the Order is only 10 issues, covering from its origins to its demise as a public-relations-focused team.

